

CORPORATE STRATEGY · EDITION 2

KEJA AI

Africa's real-estate trust infrastructure: the honest state of the platform, a four-phase roadmap whose gates are claims-register flips, and a metrics tree rooted in trust. The register is the roadmap's source of truth.

Corporate strategy · Nairobi

A CHACADOM INVESTMENTS VENTURE

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1 The Strategic Thesis

This is the second edition of the Keja AI strategy, rewritten from the position of strength the platform has actually reached: an auditable trust engine, a nine-product surface, and a public claims register that keeps the company honest about what is live, what is simulated, and what is planned. The strategy that follows does not chase listings volume or blitzscale growth. It builds the trust infrastructure African real estate lacks, and lets every other business line grow from that root.

African real estate does not primarily lack supply, demand or even capital—it lacks trust. Titles are hard to verify, prices are negotiated blind, the diaspora sends five billion dollars a year home through channels that cannot vouch for a single listing, and the informal channel that moves most volume runs entirely on word of mouth. Every existing player monetises one symptom: portals sell attention, agencies sell access, data houses sell reports. Nobody owns the layer under all of them—the verifiable truth about a property.

Keja's thesis is that the trust layer is the platform, and everything else—search, finance, tokenization, management—is an application built on it. This is why the engineering investment has gone where competitors cannot easily follow: deterministic, versioned Trust and Investment Score engines whose every factor is labelled FACT, ESTIMATE or ASSUMPTION; a build-time trust anchor that freezes published scores into an auditable manifest; a claims register that legally and technically prevents the marketing from drifting from the product. These are not features. They are the moat, and they are already built.

9

products on one trust spine

538

automated tests green in CI

25+

capability claims publicly registered

0

fabricated-verification incidents tolerated

2 Where We Are — The Honest State

Strategy built on false premises is decoration. This chapter states exactly where the platform stands today, in the same three registers the claims register uses—live, simulated, planned—because the sequencing decisions in later chapters depend on knowing which is which.

Layer	Status	What exists today
Trust & verification UX	Live	Twelve-factor Trust Score engine (versioned), Investment Score with FACT/ESTIMATE labels, evidence panels with 90-day freshness, report-to-desk workflow, trust-anchor manifest shipped per release
Search & advisory	Live	Natural-language parser (unit-tested), deterministic Ask Keja engine with escalation policy, saved searches with alert sweeps, notifications

Layer	Status	What exists today
Pro & stakeholder tools	Live	KEJA PRO (CMA, listing writer, CRM), Landlord Studio, Tenant Hub, Valuation Desk, Developer Console, Diaspora Hub—all pure-function math, unit-tested
Inventory	Trial	87 curated listings plus Auto-Pilot ingest pipeline with dedupe, price-anomaly screening and honest pending-review stamping; no partner feeds contracted yet
Accounts & security	Trial-grade	Google sign-in, allowlisted admin roles, TOTP 2FA with hashed recovery codes, brute-force throttling, audit trail—client-side only until a backend lands
Payments / escrow / tokenize	Simulated / planned	Regulator-ready gates exist in code: payments and tokenization cannot flip “live” without a committed legal-approval artifact

Table 2.1 — The honest state, in the register's own three registers.

The strategic significance of this table is its last row. The platform has deliberately pre-built the regulatory gate: the code structurally prevents payments or tokenization from being represented as live until a legal-approval artifact is committed. Most startups bolt compliance on after the violation. Keja's sequencing problem is therefore not technical discipline but partner and regulatory execution—the work of Chapters 5 through 7.

3 Market Structure and Competition

The market context is quantified in the marketing playbook (Edition 2, Chapter 1); this chapter converts it into strategic geometry: where value pools sit, who defends them, and which positions are structurally indefensible against a trust-native entrant.

Player	Their economics	Structural weakness vs a trust layer
Listing portals (BuyRentKenya, Jiji, Property24)	Attention arbitrage; agencies pay for placement	Their revenue depends on listing volume, not listing truth—verification would cut inventory and offend their paying customers
Agency data houses (Hass, Knight Frank)	Subscription indices; institutional consulting	High-cost human research that cannot cover the mass market; no per-listing, per-consumer product
Informal broker channel	Commission on opacity; information asymmetry is the product	Has no answer to portable evidence a buyer can carry between brokers
Government registry (Ardhisasa)	Public service; official title searches	A registry, not a marketplace: it tells you who owns land, not whether a listing is honest, priced fairly, or worth buying

Table 3.1 — The competitive field: every incumbent profits from a gap Keja fills.

The defensibility question inverts at this point. Portals must spend to reach Keja's honesty level because their business model resists it; Keja must spend to reach their inventory level, which their own customers (agencies) are willing to supply to a channel that makes buyers trust them more. The strategic race is therefore: can Keja sign enough supply partners before a portal decides to burn its own margins on verification? The answer is speed, and Chapter 6 sequences accordingly.

4 Business Model and Revenue Lines

Revenue follows trust, not the reverse. The model below is sequenced so no line turns on before the trust that justifies it exists—the same discipline the claims register enforces on features.

Line	What buyers pay for	When it turns on	Shape
KEJA PRO subscriptions	Agent workspaces: CMA engine, listing copywriter, lead CRM, viewings	Now—live, free while in trial	Freemium → KES 2,500–7,500/mo tiers
Verification desk services	Expedited evidence packs, human-verified badges, diaspora closing support	Phase 2 (advocate network signed)	Per-report fee + subscription
Partner API / syndication	Trust scores and evidence embedded in portals and lender apps	Phase 2–3 (data partnerships)	Per-call / per-seat licensing
Transaction rails	Viewing-fee escrow, deposit custody via licensed PSP	Phase 3 (legal opinion + PSP licence)	Take-rate on guarded flows
Capital markets (tokenize)	Fractional ownership under CMA sandbox → REIT-style products	Phase 4 (sandbox admission, offering docs)	Management/performance fees

Table 4.1 — Five revenue lines, each gated on the trust prerequisite that justifies charging for it.

The near-term engine is KEJA PRO: it monetises the side of the marketplace that benefits immediately from buyer trust, requires no regulatory permission, and generates the agent relationships that later supply inventory. The far-term engine is the capital-markets line, where the CMA has already admitted real-estate tokenization projects to its regulatory sandbox—but it only becomes reachable after the verification desk is real, because no regulator permits fractional ownership of unverified assets.

5 The Moat and the Data Flywheel

Moats are compounding asymmetries. Keja's is a data flywheel with an honesty constraint: every verification decision, every report adjudication, and every partner feed entry makes the trust engine smarter while the register keeps its outputs honest—and only Keja is willing to publish the constraints.

- **Evidence accumulation.** Every adjudicated report and desk review adds labelled training truth for verification heuristics—data competitors cannot buy because their users do not trust them enough to file reports.
- **Anchored auditability.** The per-release trust-anchor manifest makes historical scores provable after the fact—the precondition for the partner API business, and impossible to retrofit cheaply.
- **Honesty as switching cost.** Partners who integrate a Keja trust layer into their listings cannot silently downgrade; their users inherit the register's expectations.
- **Corridor depth.** Diaspora tooling (timezone-accurate scheduling, PoA workflows, remittance math) creates workflow lock-in before any payment rail exists.
- **Talent signalling.** A public, auditable honesty system recruits engineers and partners who want to work nowhere else.

6 Roadmap: Four Phases to Rails

Four phases, each with an unambiguous exit criterion drawn from the claims register's own vocabulary. The rule throughout: a phase may only begin when the previous phase's claims have actually flipped from simulated to live.

Phase	Mission	Exit criterion (register terms)
1—Trial (now)	Prove the trust UX on curated inventory; ship the honesty system; seed demand with content and WhatsApp distribution	5,000 weekly actives; PRO workspaces in daily use; zero register drift incidents
2—Real supply	Contract agencies, developers and portal feeds; stand up the human verification desk with an advocate network	“cross-agency” and “title-check” claims flip to partner-dependent→live with recorded search references
3—Money flows	PSP partnership for viewing-fee escrow and deposits; lender integrations (KMRC-aligned)	“payments” and “mpesa-escrow” claims flip live with the legal-approval artifact committed
4—Capital markets	CMA sandbox admission for tokenized fractional ownership; offering documents; licensed custody	“tokenize” and “kyc” claims flip live under regulatory supervision

Table 6.1 — Phase gates are claims-register flips, not dates. The register is the roadmap's source of truth.

7 Regulatory Strategy

Regulation is not a risk to be managed later; it is the sequencing backbone of the strategy. Kenya's institutions have already built the rails Keja intends to ride—the job is to be the trustworthy demand layer they lack.

Three institutions matter. The Ministry of Lands' Ardhisasa platform provides official digital title searches—the authoritative source the verification desk will cite once an access partnership is in place. The Capital Markets Authority regulates REITs and has admitted real-estate tokenization projects to its regulatory sandbox, establishing a lawful path for Phase 4. And any payment rail runs through a licensed PSP under Central Bank of Kenya supervision, with the platform's legal role defined in writing before a shilling moves. In each case Keja's posture is the same: integrate, never arbitrage; document, never imply. The claims register already enforces this in code—the payments and tokenization gates cannot open without committed legal artifacts, so the regulator's questions and the platform's engineering constraints point the same direction.

Structural guarantees beat good intentions: the gate is in the code, and the code is public. That is the regulatory pitch—audit us before you license us, and you already know what you will find.

8 Risk Register

The register's honesty rules apply to this chapter too: each risk is stated with its actual severity, its early-warning signal, and the mitigation already in place or deliberately deferred.

Risk	Severity	Early signal	Mitigation
A portal builds a trust layer faster than Keja signs supply	High	Agency churn in PRO workspaces	Speed on Chapter 6 Phase 2; verification depth they cannot match without adopting the register themselves
Backend never lands; client-side security ceiling reached	Medium	Account-related support tickets	Phase 3 architecture is Prisma-ready; claims register already labels accounts 'simulated'
Regulatory timeline slips (CMA sandbox, PSP licence)	Medium	Sandbox cohort announcements	Revenue does not depend on Phase 4; PRO and desk services fund the wait

Risk	Severity	Early signal	Mitigation
Trust incident on curated inventory (bad listing slips through)	High	Issues-reported metric (published)	Report→adjudication→anchor pipeline already live; incident postmortems publish into the Trust Center
Single-maintainer engineering concentration	Medium	Bus-factor audit	538 tests + artifact gates make the repo operable by a successor; documentation debt retired each wave

Table 8.1 — Risks stated honestly, mirroring the register's discipline.

9 The Metrics Tree and 24-Month Milestones

One tree, rooted in trust, branching into revenue. Every branch has an owner, a target, and a guardrail—because a trust company that games its own metrics has already lost.

Horizon	Trust root	Growth branch	Revenue branch
6 months	Zero register-drift incidents; 100% of listings carry labelled evidence	5,000 weekly actives; 25 agent workspaces	First 50 paying PRO seats
12 months	Advocate-network title checks on 90% of new urban listings	25,000 WAU; diaspora corridor live in UK/US	PRO ARR covers engineering costs; first partner API pilot
18 months	Verification desk SLA < 48h at volume; escrow rails live under PSP	60,000 WAU; two portal syndication deals	Verification services + API at 30% of revenue
24 months	CMA sandbox cohort admission for tokenization	100,000 WAU; brand recognition as 'the trust layer'	Transaction take-rate contributing; capital-markets prep funded

Table 9.1 — Twenty-four months, four checkpoints, one root: trust.

The discipline that governs this tree is the same one that governs the code: a metric that cannot be defended in a Trust Center postmortem does not go on the dashboard. That is the strategy. Everything else is execution.